

Using the API

REST API endpoint are accessible at addresses under `/api/data` as outlined in the [schema](#) information. For example METARs are found at <https://aviationweather.gov/api/data>. Most requests require query parameters in order to specify constraints of the data being requested. For example the latest METAR from Kansas City International in JSON format can be requested by specifying the four letter ICAO identifier with <https://aviationweather.gov/api/data/metar?ids=KMCI&format=json>.

Requests may be made using most web browsers, command line utilities, and programming language libraries using modern HTTPS connections.

Some parameters and response schema changed in September 2025 -- please see [Recent Changes](#) and the [OpenAPI](#) documentation.

Guidelines

- Please carefully consider requests to limit load on the system.
- Set a custom *user agent* to prevent automated filtering inadvertently blocking valid traffic.
- Wait between consecutive requests — maximum 100 requests per minute.
- Exceeding request limits will result in access being temporarily blocked.

Restrictions

- All requests are rate limited to 100 requests per minute and all API endpoints should not be consumed more frequently than 1 request/min per thread.
- Most endpoints return a maximum of 400 entries (please consider using cache files for larger requests).
- Cross-origin resource sharing is not permitted at this time.

Responses

- Status code 204 is returned for valid requests with no data available (except GeoJSON).
- JSON and XML formats return standardized error messages across endpoints.
- Errors are returned using standard HTTP status codes as outline in the table below.

HTTP Status Code	Description
204 No Content	Request is valid however there is no data to be returned. For example no recent METARs available for a particular station or no SIGMETs valid at a particular time.
400 Invalid Request	The request is invalid in some way. This could include: Invalid parameters like format or date Missing parameters required to complete a request The URL is incorrect in some way.
404 Not Found	The endpoint or specific item requested does not exist.
429 Too Many Requests	Too many requests have been sent. You might see this error code when rate limits are applied. See

	Restrictions above.
500 Internal Server	The request may be valid but the system was unable to serve the request due to an error.
502 Bad Gateway 504 Gateway Timeout	Temporary service disruption.